

against longevity risk can lead to a retirement income gap that might be difficult to fill.

TABLE 7.2 What Will Be Your Cause of Death?

	Estimate	Actual
Heart Disease	22%	34%
Cancer	18%	23%
Other Natural	33%	35%
Accident	32%	5%
Homicide	10%	1%
Other Unnatural	11%	2%
TOTAL	126%	100%

Source: Life Insurance Marketing Research Association (LIMRA) Survey 2004.

On the other hand, factors that are likely to improve longevity are continuously being studied and, in addition to data that I have summarized in Chapter 2, there are some fascinating findings emerging from demographers, biologists, and gerontologists. This is a topic of ongoing and continuing research. According to a recent study by the U.S. Society of Actuaries (www.soa.org), there are actually twelve factors that affect or influence retirement mortality. They are

- Age
- Gender
- Race and Ethnicity
- Education
- Income
- Occupation
- Marital status
- Religion
- Health behaviors
- Smoking
- Alcohol consumption
- Obesity